Lou Chang

Backend Engineer | APIs, SQL & Cloud Infrastructure

Toronto, ON, Canada

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Summary

Backend engineer with 5+ years maintaining multi-client web systems and APIs. Strongest work is in .NET and SQL Server: API design, SQL performance, and production debugging across application and data layers. Recent contract work adds Python/FastAPI, Legal AI document automation, and Terraform-managed cloud delivery.

Experience

Software Engineer - Backend & Cloud Infrastructure (Contract) — Toronto, ON
Independent Consulting — **Sep. 2024 - Present**

- **Backend refactor -** Reworked a FastAPI prototype into domain modules for API, persistence, and providers; added SQLAlchemy repositories, Alembic migrations, Shopify OAuth onboarding, validation, and tests.
- **Legal AI document automation -** Added dynamic DOCX rows for variable-length financial/property records in Ontario Form 13.1, reducing manual Word edits; reindexed fields, preserved court formatting, and added FormKit/YAML regression tests.

Web Development Engineer — Taipei, Taiwan
Duotify Inc. — **Jun. 2020 - Jan. 2024**

Maintained about 12-14 client projects concurrently and worked across 20+ over the role. The examples below are selected, separate client systems.

- **Emergency medicine association website & member system -** During annual conference registration, cut accounting, event, and membership admin workflows for about 3,000 members from 5-8 minutes/timeouts to about 5 seconds (fastest 0.4) by moving multi-table LINQ/AutoMapper logic into SQL Server procedures, views, and functions.
- **Cathay Financial Holdings internal platform -** Took over a 40-50 API .NET 5 system mid-project, built the company's first AWS dev/test environment under restricted client access, and delivered 4-5 APIs through on-site acceptance.
- **Local-business platform -** Built 20-30 .NET 5 REST APIs for a greenfield coupon, merchant, and membership platform; used JWT/database transactions and coordinated NSwag contracts with an Angular 12 frontend engineer.
- **Top-three Taiwan used-car marketplace -** Helped restore service during a week-long traffic/scraper incident (50-70k monthly visits) by tracing App Service saturation in Azure Monitor and configuring autoscaling while the team rerouted traffic.

ERP Applications Engineer — Taipei, Taiwan
Unitech Computer Co., Ltd. — **Mar. 2019 - May 2020**

- **B2B ordering & modernization -** Maintained a nationwide AngularJS/ASP.NET MVC ordering platform across SQL Server, PostgreSQL, and Oracle; fixed production/data issues and built an Angular 8/MVC 5 modernization PoC.

Selected Project

content-i18n | Go Translation Orchestration
Built a Go translation tool with CLI/MCP, translation queues, batch processing, DeepL/Google adapters, and validation for document structure, code blocks, links, and leftover source-language text.

Education & Certification

Seneca Polytechnic — Toronto, Canada
Diploma, Computer Programming — **Aug. 2025**

Hwa Hsia University of Technology — New Taipei City, Taiwan
Bachelor's, Information Management — **Jun. 2020**

Microsoft — Taipei, Taiwan
AZ-900: Azure Fundamentals — **Feb. 2022**

Technologies

Backend & Data	Python/FastAPI, C#/.NET, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Oracle, SQLAlchemy
APIs & Delivery	REST APIs, OpenAPI/NSwag, JWT, Docker, AWS, GCP, Terraform, GitHub Actions
Operations	Azure Monitor, CloudWatch, GitLab CE, Linux, Bash